Away from the world of espionage, the Indira Gandhi government tried to normalise India's economic relationship with Iraq and by 1982, around ninety-seven Indian companies were settled in the region to execute infrastructure and other projects worth over five thousand crore rupees. The foreign minister of Iraq, Sa'dun Hammadi, made a trip to New Delhi in July 1982 as the personal envoy of Saddam Hussein to discuss vexing issues in the Middle East due to the continuing war. The R&AW's intelligence processed by analysts ensured that India could formulate a well-carved diplomatic strategy to deal with the countries hostile to each other. The raw political information and the roles of key players were double-checked to protect India's interest and to decide the scale of any interference made by India in such a crisis.

Russian Roulette

Another R&AW analysis provides a peek into the internal tussle for leadership in the friendly country of the USSR. Leonid Brezhnev was seriously ill in early 1982 and speculation was rife about his successor. The Russian president had enjoyed a very close relationship with two Congress party prime ministers of India—Lal Bahadur Shastri and Indira Gandhi. Ever since he assumed power in 1964, Brezhnev had made sure there were opportunities for both countries to expand and deepen their mutually advantageous cooperation in all fields without interference by either side in each other's internal matters. During a meeting with Indira Gandhi in New Delhi in 1980, against the backdrop of the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan, Brezhnev had promised a substantial increase in the supply of crude oil to India and also technological support to set up industries. Now that he lay ill, the R&AW needed to figure out the backgrounds, strengths, points of weakness and intentions